

Q.6a (20 marks): Antiquity of iron age in India

Q. (a)

प्रकार भिन्न है?

Discuss the antiquity of iron age in India in context of new evidences. How does it differ from other parts of the world?

20

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नहीं लिखना
चाहिए
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Iron age denotes

to time period when human
first started using Iron implements.

Traditionally it started around
1000 B.C. during Later Vedic period.



Pointed Grey
ware

Tools of iron age.

Antiquity of iron age in India

① Traditional view

a) Began in the first millenium
B.C. years after arrival of
Vedic Aryans.

b) Depend on tools, texts (Vedas)
7 site distribution.

c) Early evidence
from north Indian
river basins like
Indus, Ganga, etc.



fig: initial
spread of
Iron age

Cultural components

① Tools: iron implements
however use of bronze
7 copper continued

② Techniques: iron smelting, Copper
smelting, mining, etc

③ Social Climate

↳ (a) Emergence of private
property

↳ (b) settled habitations usually
of wattle 7 mud.

↳ (c) Social inequity exists as
some more rich than
others

↳ (c) Economy pastoral & agricultural

उम्मीदवारों को इस हार्शिए में नहीं लिखना चाहिए
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② New evidences

① Excavations in Deccan, Tamil Nadu has yielded evidence of iron age during Sangam period in South India.

② Sites like Sinoli provide evidence of iron age earlier than thought before in Ganga Yamuna doab.

Differ from other parts of the world

① From Africa

a) Earlier start in Africa, iron age began directly after Lithic age with no evidence of Chalcolithic & bronze age.

② From Europe & West Asia

a) Elaborate excavations in ~~The~~ Anatolia, Eastern Europe has revealed complex iron age culture in these region.

b) Settled agriculture was thriving in Mesopotamia & on eastern coast of Mediterranean.

③ From South East Asia

a) Late emergence of iron age, limited excavations & difficult to obtain cultural remains due to climate & vegetation.

Thus, with some common global features, the iron age also show significant regional variation.